



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/8895/KE-551/2023

Name and Address of the Complainant : Syed Muhammad Mehdi, General Manager, M/s. Capital Book Co. Head Office, Mezzanine Floor, Plot No. 311/C, Commercial Area, Block-02, PECHS, Tariq Road, Karachi.

Name of the Agency Complained against : Aror University of Art, Architecture, Design & Heritage Sindh, Sukkur

Name & Designation of Investigation Officer : Syed Farrukh Hahib
Director, Regional Office, Karachi (East)

Subject :- **INACTION ON REPRESENTATION MADE FOR PAYMENT OF RS.15,053,676/- ON ACCOUNT OF SUPPLY OF BOOKS IN THE YEAR 2022.**

THE COMPLAINT

Syed Muhammad Mehdi, General Manager, M/s Capital Book Co., filed a complaint dated 20.10.2023 alleging non-payment of dues by Aror University of Art, Architecture, Design & Heritage Sindh, Sukkur. He stated that in May 2022 the University invited quotations for books, against which purchase orders were issued. On directions of the then Vice-Chancellor, Dr. Samreen Asim, books, many of which were not available locally, were imported and supplied to the University, followed by submission of invoices. The bills were forwarded for payment; however, after change of Vice-Chancellor, the payment allegedly stalled. Despite repeated follow-ups, the complainant was informed that only a partial amount could be paid and that the new Vice-Chancellor was not bound by commitments of the previous incumbent. The complainant claimed an outstanding amount of Rs.15,053,676/- and approached this office for redressal.

PROCEEDINGS

2. After admission of complaint by condoning delay under Section 10 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991, (amended up to date), as well as receiving mandatory Affidavit on Form "A" and other relevant documents. The report was called from the Agency. In response the Director Finance, Aror University, vide letter dated 27.02.2024, reported that most of the supplied books were of old editions, allegedly contrary to HEC policy requiring procurement of latest editions. It was further stated that the books were already in the vendor's stock and not specifically imported on the University's request. The agency also disputed the claimed amount and stated that, after verification, an amount of approximately Rs.1,933,914/- was found payable and was under process.

3. In his rejoinder dated 26.03.2024, the complainant contended that the books were supplied strictly in accordance with approved lists, quotations, and purchase orders issued by the University after due approval. He argued that responsibility for any policy violation lay with the University authorities who approved and ordered the books. He further asserted that the University itself acknowledged outstanding liabilities during audit proceedings.

Contd.....

(2)

4. The Registrar, Aror University, vide letter dated 10.06.2024, assured that efforts were being made to resolve the matter amicably.

5. During pendency of the complaint, the complainant informed this office that the new Vice-Chancellor had refused to make payment, whereupon he retrieved the supplied books and expressed his intention not to pursue the complaint further.

FINDINGS

6. I have examined the case file and perused correspondence, reports and rejoinders etc., and observed that:

- i. The record shows that the complainant supplied books pursuant to quotations invited and purchase orders issued by the University. The books were received without contemporaneous objection.
- ii. The university however, raised certain objections upon complainant's claim of having imported some books, terming these as incorrect and disputed the claim of Rs.15,053,676/-.
- iii. However, the complainant after having seen the uncompromising stance of the University, retrieved the supplied books and stated that he did not wish to pursue the matter further.

DECISION

7. In view of the foregoing and in light of the complainant's statement that he has retrieved the supplied books and did not wish to pursue the matter, the complaint is therefore disposed of on account of non-prosecution and consigned to record.

Given under my hand and seal of office



Sd /-

Muhammad Sohail Rajput
Sitara-e-Imtiaz. PAS
Ombudsman Sindh

Karachi, dated 16, 02, 2026